

CHAPTER 3: Snacks & Sweets (The Craving Killers)

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51. Roasted Garlic Makhana (Fox Nuts)

GI Rating: Low (35) | Prep: 2m | Cook: 10m

- **Why it works:** Makhana (fox nuts) is a low-glycemic, low-calorie snack high in protein and fiber. Roasting them in ghee provides healthy fats that slow down digestion and gastric emptying, keeping blood sugar stable. Garlic adds anti-inflammatory benefits.
- **Ingredients:** 2 cups Makhana, 1 tbsp Ghee, 1 tsp Garlic powder, ¼ tsp turmeric, Salt and black pepper to taste.
- **Method:** Heat ghee in a heavy-bottomed pan. Add the makhana and roast on low flame for 8-10 minutes, stirring constantly until they are light golden and crispy. Turn off the flame, add the garlic powder, turmeric, salt, and black pepper. Toss well so the spices coat the makhana uniformly. Let it cool and store in an airtight jar.

52. Kala Chana Chaat (Black Chickpea Salad)

GI Rating: Very Low (22) | Prep: 5m | Cook: 0m (if pre-boiled)

- **Why it works:** Black chickpeas are exceptionally high in dietary fiber, particularly insoluble fiber which is not digested by the body and helps improve insulin sensitivity. Tossing them with raw onions, cucumber, and tomatoes adds raw enzymes, vitamin C, and prebiotic fiber.
- **Ingredients:** 1 cup boiled Black Chickpeas (Kala Chana), ½ cup chopped Cucumber, ¼ cup chopped Onion, ¼ cup chopped Tomato, 1 Green Chilli (finely chopped), 1 tbsp fresh lemon juice, ½ tsp Chaat Masala, Salt, fresh coriander.
- **Method:** Combine the boiled black chickpeas and all the chopped vegetables in a mixing bowl. Add the green chilli, chaat masala, salt, and fresh lemon juice. Toss well to combine. Garnish with chopped coriander and serve cold.

53. Cucumber & Hung Curd Sandwiches (No Bread)

GI Rating: Very Low (Under 15) | Prep: 10m | Cook: 0m

- **Why it works:** Swapping starch-heavy white bread with thick cucumber slices eliminates simple carbohydrates. The filling of hung curd (concentrated Greek-style yogurt) is rich in protein and calcium, creating a low-calorie, hydrating snack that does not spike blood sugar.
- **Ingredients:** 1 large Cucumber, ½ cup Hung Curd, 2 tbsp finely chopped bell peppers, 1 tbsp grated carrot, ¼ tsp black pepper, ¼ tsp oregano, Salt to taste.
- **Method:** Slice the cucumber into thick rounds or long, wide strips. In a bowl, mix the hung curd, chopped bell peppers, carrot, black pepper, oregano, and salt. Spread a generous tablespoon of the hung curd mixture on one cucumber slice and top with another, making a sandwich.

54. Roasted Peanuts & Paneer Mix

GI Rating: Low (Under 15) | Prep: 5m | Cook: 5m

- **Why it works:** A high-protein, high-fat, near-zero carb combination that stabilizes insulin levels. Paneer provides casein protein, which digests slowly over several hours, while peanuts contribute monounsaturated fatty acids (MUFAs) which support healthy lipid profiles.
- **Ingredients:** 50g Paneer (cut into small ½-inch cubes), ½ cup unsalted roasted Peanuts, ½ tsp Chaat Masala, ¼ tsp red chilli powder, 1 tsp Ghee.
- **Method:** Heat ghee in a small pan, add the paneer cubes, and sauté on medium heat for 2-3 minutes until lightly golden. In a bowl, toss the warm paneer, roasted peanuts, chaat masala, and red chilli powder. Serve warm.

55. Almond Flour "Nankhatai" (Sugar-Free Cookies)

GI Rating: Low (20) | Prep: 15m | Cook: 20m

- **Why it works:** Traditional nankhatai cookies are made with refined wheat flour (maida) and sugar, which cause instant blood sugar spikes. Replacing them with almond flour (high in fiber and Vitamin E) and sweetening with erythritol or stevia results in a diabetic-friendly cookie.
- **Ingredients:** 1 cup Almond Flour, ¼ cup Besan (chickpea flour), ¼ cup melted Ghee, 3 tbsp Erythritol or stevia powder, ½ tsp Cardamom powder, 1 tbsp chopped Pistachios.
- **Method:** In a bowl, whisk the ghee, sweetener, and cardamom powder until fluffy. Fold in the almond flour and besan. Knead gently to form a soft dough (do not add water). Shape the dough into small round balls and flatten them slightly. Press a few chopped pistachios on top of each. Bake in a preheated oven at 160°C for 15-18 minutes until the bottoms are light golden. Let them cool completely to firm up.

56. Stevia-Sweetened Gajar Ka Halwa

GI Rating: Medium (45) | Prep: 15m | Cook: 30m

- **Why it works:** Carrots have a low glycemic load because they are high in fiber. Cooking them in milk and ghee adds fats and proteins, which further slow down glucose absorption. Replacing sugar with stevia removes the glycemic spike, letting you enjoy this classic dessert.
- **Ingredients:** 500g Carrots (grated), 2 cups Double-toned Milk, 2 tbsp Ghee, 1 tsp stevia powder (or to taste), ½ tsp Cardamom powder, 5-6 Almonds (slivered).
- **Method:** Heat ghee in a deep pan, add the grated carrots, and sauté for 8-10 minutes. Pour in the milk and bring to a boil. Simmer on low-medium heat, stirring frequently, until the milk reduces and is fully absorbed by the carrots. Stir in the stevia powder and cardamom powder. Cook for another 2-3 minutes. Garnish with slivered almonds and serve warm.

57. Chia Seed "Falooda"

GI Rating: Zero/Low (15) | Prep: 5m | Cook: 0m (needs soaking)

- **Why it works:** Chia seeds are comprised of almost 40% dietary fiber. When soaked, they form a mucilaginous gel that physically slows down the breakdown of carbohydrates in the intestine. Using almond milk and stevia makes it a refreshing, zero-sugar dessert.
- **Ingredients:** 2 tbsp Chia seeds, 1 cup unsweetened Almond Milk, 2-3 drops rose essence (unsweetened), 1 tsp stevia, 4-5 chopped almonds.
- **Method:** Soak the chia seeds in water for 30 minutes until gelled. Drain excess water. In a glass, mix the almond milk, rose essence, and stevia. Add the soaked chia seeds and stir well. Chill in the refrigerator for 1 hour. Top with chopped almonds before serving.

58. Peanut Butter Apple Slices

GI Rating: Low (28) | Prep: 2m | Cook: 0m

- **Why it works:** Apples are rich in soluble pectin fiber, which helps control blood glucose levels. Pairing apple slices with unsweetened peanut butter adds healthy fats and protein, which slow the absorption of the fruit's natural sugars.
- **Ingredients:** 1 medium Apple (sliced), 2 tbsp Unsweetened Peanut Butter (100% peanuts, no added oil or sugar).
- **Method:** Wash and slice the apple. Arrange the slices on a plate. Serve with a side of unsweetened peanut butter for dipping or spread the peanut butter evenly onto each slice.

59. Roasted Pumpkin & Sunflower Seeds

GI Rating: Low (15) | Prep: 5m | Cook: 5m

- **Why it works:** Pumpkin and sunflower seeds are rich in magnesium, zinc, and healthy polyunsaturated fats. Magnesium plays a critical role in glucose metabolism and increases insulin sensitivity, making this seed mix an excellent snack.
- **Ingredients:** ½ cup Pumpkin seeds, ½ cup Sunflower seeds, ¼ tsp black salt, ¼ tsp roasted cumin powder.
- **Method:** Heat a dry pan on low heat. Add the pumpkin and sunflower seeds. Dry roast for 4-5 minutes, stirring continuously, until they begin to pop and turn lightly brown. Turn off the heat, sprinkle with black salt and cumin powder, and toss. Let it cool and store in a jar.

60. Lauki (Bottle Gourd) Kheer

GI Rating: Low (20) | Prep: 10m | Cook: 20m

- **Why it works:** Replaces the starch-heavy rice used in traditional kheer with grated bottle gourd. Lauki is 96% water and high in fiber, while milk provides calcium and protein. Sweetened with stevia, it offers a creamy, traditional dessert with a very low glycemic load.

- **Ingredients:** 1 cup grated Bottle Gourd (Lauki), 2 cups Milk, 1 tbsp Ghee, ½ tsp Cardamom powder, ½ tsp stevia powder, 1 tbsp chopped almonds.
- **Method:** Squeeze out the water from the grated bottle gourd. Heat ghee in a pan and sauté the grated bottle gourd for 5 minutes until soft. Add the milk and bring to a boil. Simmer on low heat for 12-15 minutes until the milk thickens. Stir in the cardamom powder and stevia. Simmer for 2 minutes. Garnish with chopped almonds and serve chilled.

61. Boiled Peanut Chaat (South Indian style)

GI Rating: Low (14) | Prep: 10m (with boiled peanuts) | Cook: 5m

- **Why it works:** Boiling peanuts preserves their healthy fats and protein without the added calories of frying. Tossing them with mustard seeds and curry leaves adds dietary fiber and digestive support, making this a classic, slow-burning South Indian snack.
- **Ingredients:** 1 cup raw Peanuts (boiled in salted water until soft), ½ tsp Mustard seeds, 1 dry red chilli, 5-6 Curry leaves, ¼ tsp Turmeric, 1 tsp Oil, lemon juice.
- **Method:** Drain the boiled peanuts. Heat oil in a pan, add mustard seeds, dry red chilli, and curry leaves. Once the seeds crackle, add turmeric and the boiled peanuts. Toss on medium heat for 3 minutes. Turn off the flame, drizzle fresh lemon juice, and mix.

62. Paneer Tikka (air-fried snack size)

GI Rating: Very Low (Under 15) | Prep: 10m | Cook: 10m

- **Why it works:** Air-fried paneer marinated in spiced curd is a rich source of calcium, healthy fats, and protein. This nutrient profile triggers the release of satiety hormones like cholecystokinin, keeping you full and preventing late-night cravings.
- **Ingredients:** 150g Paneer (cut into cubes), ¼ cup Curd, ½ tsp ginger-garlic paste, ½ tsp Ajwain, ½ tsp red chilli powder, Salt, ½ tsp oil for brushing.
- **Method:** In a bowl, mix curd, ginger-garlic paste, ajwain, red chilli powder, and salt. Toss the paneer cubes in this marinade. Preheat the air fryer to 180°C. Lightly brush the marinated paneer with oil and air-fry for 8-10 minutes, turning once, until the edges are golden brown.

63. Soya Sticks (baked, not fried)

GI Rating: Low (25) | Prep: 15m | Cook: 15m

- **Why it works:** Made from protein-rich soy flour and fiber-rich chickpea flour. Baking instead of deep-frying reduces the calorie density by 60%, providing a crunchy, high-fiber, low-GI snack that satisfies salty cravings.
- **Ingredients:** ½ cup Soy flour, ½ cup Besan (chickpea flour), ½ tsp Ajwain, ½ tsp red chilli powder, 1 tbsp Oil, Salt, warm water.

- **Method:** Combine soy flour, besan, ajwain, red chilli powder, oil, and salt in a bowl. Knead into a firm dough using warm water. Shape the dough into thin, long sticks. Place them on a baking tray lined with parchment paper. Bake in a preheated oven at 180°C for 12-15 minutes until crispy.

64. Sugar-free Besan Ladoo (Made with Erythritol & Ghee)

GI Rating: Low (28) | Prep: 10m | Cook: 20m

- **Why it works:** Besan is a complex carbohydrate that digests slowly. Roasting it in pure ghee adds healthy fats that slow down glucose absorption, and erythritol provides sweetness with zero calories and zero glycemic impact.
- **Ingredients:** 1 cup Besan, ¼ cup Ghee, ½ cup Erythritol (powdered), ½ tsp Cardamom powder, 1 tbsp chopped almonds.
- **Method:** Heat ghee in a heavy-bottomed pan. Add besan and roast on low flame, stirring continuously for 15-18 minutes until it turns golden brown and releases an aromatic fragrance. Turn off the heat and let it cool slightly (warm, not hot). Stir in the powdered erythritol, cardamom powder, and almonds. Mix well, shape into round balls (ladoos), and let them set.

65. Dark Chocolate (85%+) squares with Almonds

GI Rating: Very Low (20) | Prep: 2m | Cook: 0m

- **Why it works:** Dark chocolate with 85%+ cocoa is very low in sugar and high in flavanols, which improve insulin sensitivity and support blood pressure control. Pairing it with almonds adds fiber, protein, and healthy fats.
- **Ingredients:** 2 squares of Dark Chocolate (85% cocoa or higher), 10 raw Almonds.
- **Method:** Simply pair two squares of high-quality dark chocolate with 10 raw almonds. Eat slowly, savoring the rich cocoa flavor.

66. Roasted Chana (Bhuna Chana)

GI Rating: Low (22) | Prep: 2m | Cook: 0m

- **Why it works:** Roasted split yellow chickpeas with their outer skin are extremely rich in dietary fiber and vegetable protein. It is one of the most accessible and portable low-GI snacks.
- **Ingredients:** 1 cup roasted Black Chickpeas (with skin).
- **Method:** Ready to eat. Keep a small jar of roasted chana in your bag or desk drawer for an easy, high-fiber snack that satisfies the urge to crunch.

67. Moong Dal Sprouts

GI Rating: Low (25) | Prep: 5m | Cook: 0m

- **Why it works:** Germinating green gram increases vitamin C and reduces carbohydrate content by utilizing starches for growth. Tossing raw sprouts with lemon juice and chaat masala makes a fresh, enzyme-rich snack.
- **Ingredients:** 1 cup sprouted Green Moong Dal, 2 tbsp chopped Onion, 2 tbsp chopped Tomato, 1 tbsp lemon juice, ½ tsp Chaat Masala, Salt, fresh coriander.
- **Method:** Combine the sprouts, onion, and tomato in a bowl. Add the chaat masala, salt, and fresh lemon juice. Mix well and garnish with fresh coriander.

68. Hummus with Cucumber Sticks

GI Rating: Low (18) | Prep: 10m | Cook: 0m

- **Why it works:** Hummus made from chickpeas and tahini (sesame paste) is rich in healthy fats, fiber, and protein. Serving it with cucumber sticks instead of pita bread eliminates simple starches completely.
- **Ingredients:** ½ cup boiled Chickpeas, 1 tbsp Tahini paste, 1 clove of Garlic, 1 tbsp lemon juice, 1 tsp Olive Oil, 1 large Cucumber (sliced into sticks), Salt.
- **Method:** Blend the boiled chickpeas, tahini, garlic, lemon juice, olive oil, and salt in a food processor until smooth, adding a splash of water if needed. Serve the hummus in a bowl alongside fresh cucumber sticks.

69. Keto Coconut Ladoo (Desiccated coconut + heavy cream + stevia)

GI Rating: Very Low (Under 15) | Prep: 10m | Cook: 5m

- **Why it works:** Coconut is high in medium-chain triglycerides (MCTs) and fiber. Using heavy cream and stevia allows for a creamy, decadent dessert that doesn't trigger insulin release.
- **Ingredients:** 1 cup unsweetened desiccated Coconut, 3 tbsp heavy whipping Cream, ½ tsp stevia powder, ½ tsp Cardamom powder.
- **Method:** In a bowl, mix the desiccated coconut, heavy cream, stevia, and cardamom powder. Knead gently until the mixture holds together. Shape into small balls and roll them in a little extra desiccated coconut to coat. Chill in the refrigerator for 30 minutes before serving.

70. Masala Chaach (Buttermilk)

GI Rating: Very Low (15) | Prep: 5m | Cook: 0m

- **Why it works:** A fermented dairy drink that is highly hydrating. The probiotics in curd support gut health, while cumin and black salt stimulate digestion. It is extremely low-carb and low-calorie.
- **Ingredients:** ½ cup Curd, 1 cup cold Water, ½ tsp roasted cumin powder, ¼ tsp black salt, chopped mint leaves.
- **Method:** Whisk the curd and cold water together until frothy. Stir in the roasted cumin powder, black salt, and finely chopped mint leaves. Serve cold.

71. Sugar-Free Shrikhand (Hung curd + Stevia + Saffron)

GI Rating: Very Low (15) | Prep: 10m (plus draining) | Cook: 0m

- **Why it works:** Draining whey from yogurt concentrates the protein content (casein). Saffron adds active antioxidants, and stevia provides natural sweetness, creating a thick, creamy dessert with zero glycemic impact.
- **Ingredients:** 1 cup thick Hung Curd, 1 pinch Saffron (soaked in 1 tsp warm milk), ½ tsp stevia powder, ¼ tsp Cardamom powder, chopped pistachios.
- **Method:** Whisk the hung curd in a bowl until smooth. Add the saffron milk, stevia powder, and cardamom powder. Whisk again until creamy and light. Chill in the refrigerator for 1 hour. Garnish with chopped pistachios.

72. Roasted Papads (Urad/Moong, no rice papads)

GI Rating: Low (30) | Prep: 2m | Cook: 2m

- **Why it works:** Papads made of urad dal or moong dal are rich in protein and fiber. Roasting them without oil provides a low-calorie, crispy accompaniment that satisfies crunch cravings without starchy carbohydrates.
- **Ingredients:** 2 dry Urad Dal or Moong Dal Papads.
- **Method:** Roast the papads directly over a low flame using tongs, moving them constantly to prevent burning, or microwave them for 60 seconds until puffed and crispy.

73. Tofu Nuggets (baked)

GI Rating: Very Low (Under 15) | Prep: 15m | Cook: 15m

- **Why it works:** Cubes of tofu coated in roasted chickpea flour and spices, then baked until crisp. A highly nutritious, low-GI snack that provides plant protein and minerals.
- **Ingredients:** 150g firm Tofu (cut into bite-sized cubes), 2 tbsp Besan, ½ tsp garlic powder, ½ tsp red chilli powder, Salt, 1 tsp Oil.
- **Method:** Mix besan, garlic powder, red chilli powder, and salt. Coat the tofu cubes in a tiny amount of oil, then toss them in the besan mixture to coat. Place on a baking sheet and bake at 200°C for 12-15 minutes, turning once, until crispy.

74. Walnut & Cinnamon Mix

GI Rating: Very Low (15) | Prep: 2m | Cook: 3m

- **Why it works:** Walnuts are rich in alpha-linolenic acid (Omega-3). Cinnamon contains methylhydroxylchalcone polymer (MHCP), which mimics insulin and helps lower blood glucose levels.
- **Ingredients:** ½ cup Walnuts, ½ tsp Cinnamon powder, ½ tsp Ghee.

- **Method:** Heat ghee in a pan, add walnuts and roast on low heat for 2-3 minutes. Turn off the heat, sprinkle with cinnamon powder, and toss well. Allow to cool.

75. Guava slices with Black Salt (Kala Namak)

GI Rating: Low (20) | Prep: 3m | Cook: 0m

- **Why it works:** Guava has a high dietary fiber content (especially pectin) and a low glycemic index. Sprinkling with black salt adds a savory taste while the fruit provides vitamin C and potassium.
- **Ingredients:** 1 medium ripe but firm Guava, ½ tsp Black Salt (Kala Namak).
- **Method:** Wash and slice the guava into wedges. Arrange on a plate, sprinkle with black salt, and enjoy.